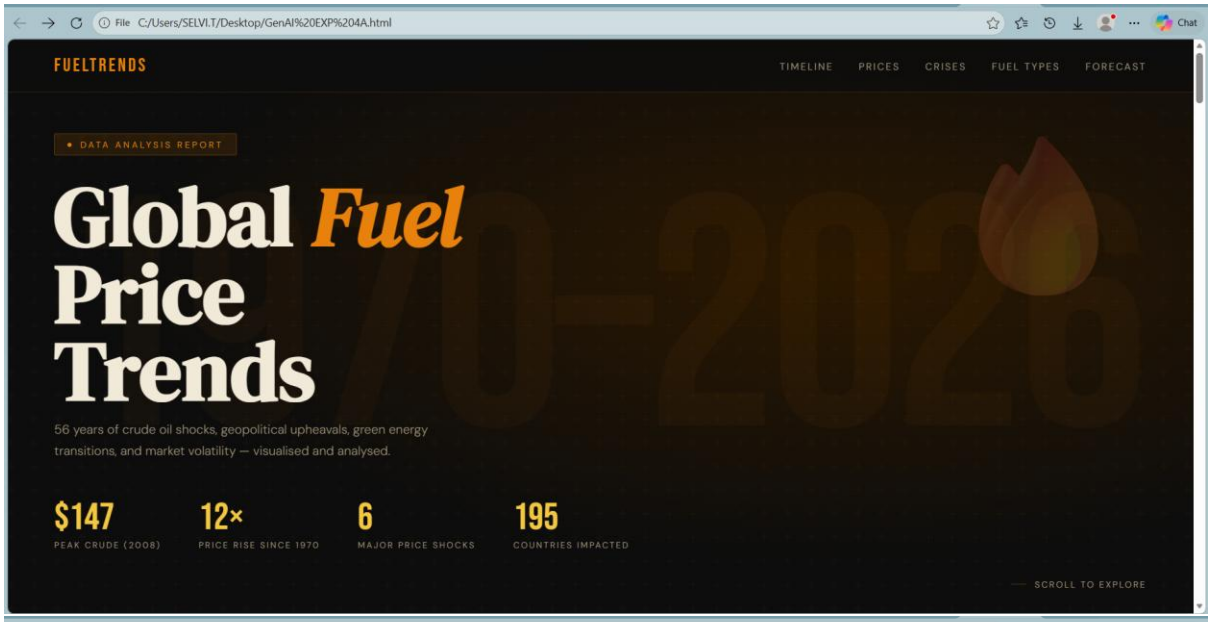
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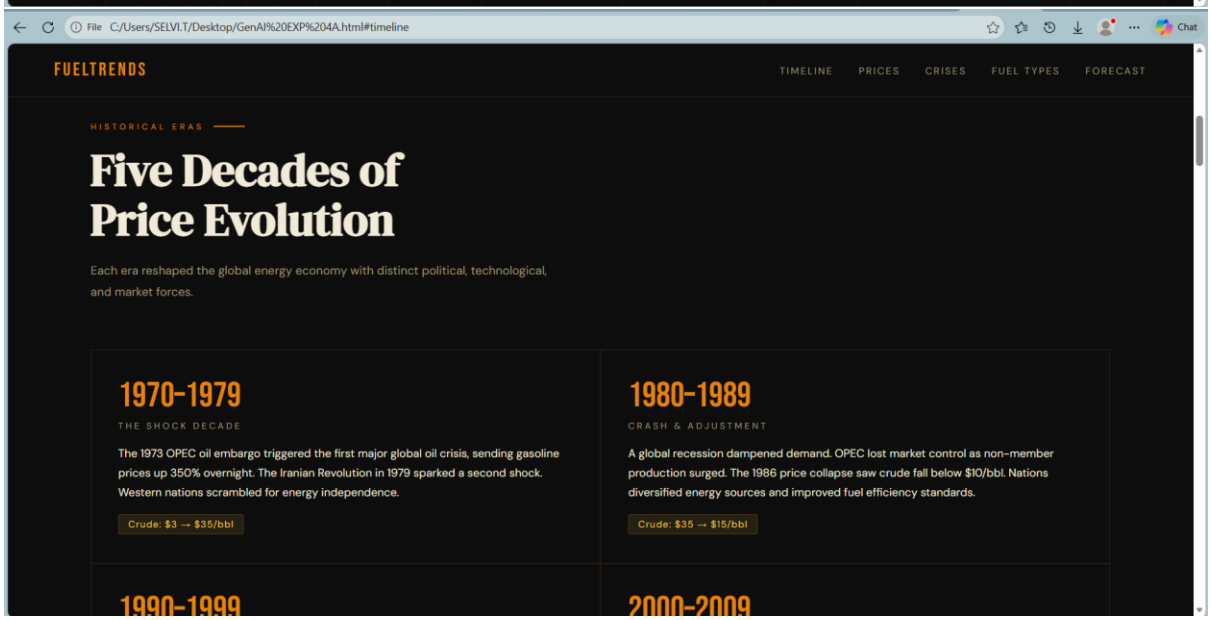
FUELTRENDS
TIMELINE PRICES CRISES FUEL TYPES FORECAST
DATA ANALYSIS REPORT
Global Fuel Price Trends
56 years of crude oil shocks, geopolitical upheavals, green energy transitions, and market volatility — visualised and analysed.
$147
PEAK CRUDE (2008)
12×
PRICE RISE SINCE 1970
6
MAJOR PRICE SHOCKS
195
COUNTRIES IMPACTED
SCROLL TO EXPLORE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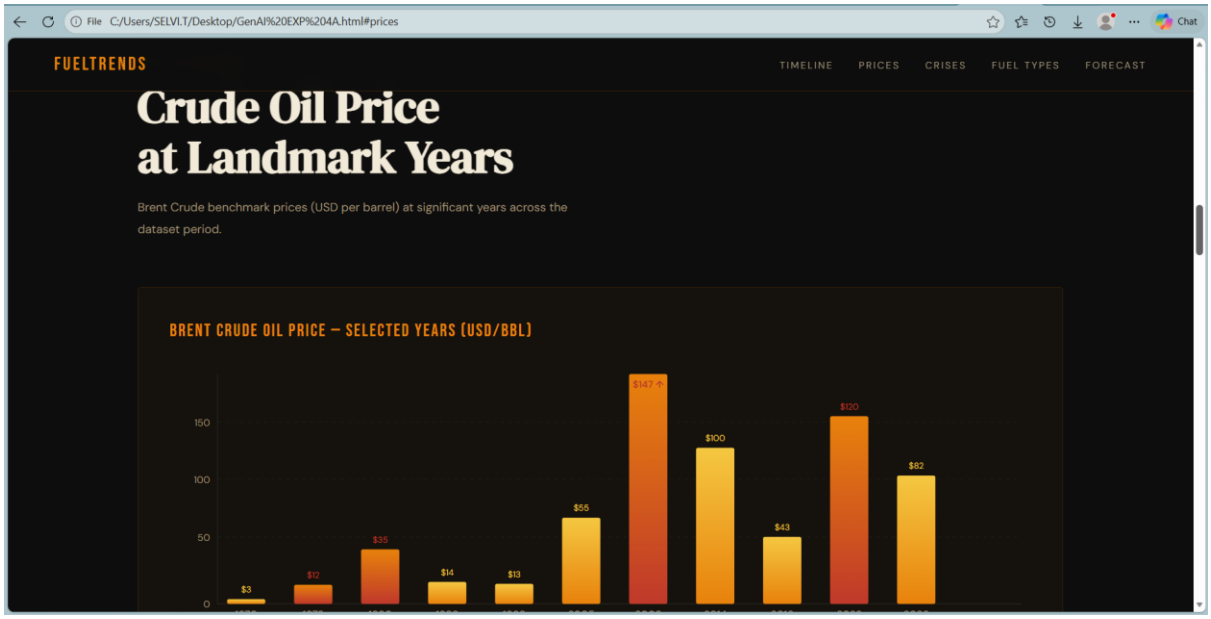
FUELTRENDS
TIMELINE PRICES CRISES FUEL TYPES FORECAST
HISTORICAL ERAS
Five Decades of Price Evolution
Each era reshaped the global energy economy with distinct political, technological, and market forces.
1970–1979
THE SHOCK DECADE
The 1973 OPEC oil embargo triggered the first major global oil crisis, sending gasoline prices up 350% overnight. The Iranian Revolution in 1979 sparked a second shock. Western nations scrambled for energy independence.
Crude: $3 → $35/bbl
1980–1989
CRASH & ADJUSTMENT
A global recession dampened demand. OPEC lost market control as non-member production surged. The 1986 price collapse saw crude fall below $10/bbl. Nations diversified energy sources and improved fuel efficiency standards.
Crude: $35 → $15/bbl
1990–1999
2000–2009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FUELTRENDS
TIMELINE PRICES CRISES FUEL TYPES FORECAST
Crude Oil Price at Landmark Years
Brent Crude benchmark prices (USD per barrel) at significant years across the dataset period.
BRENT CRUDE OIL PRICE — SELECTED YEARS (USD/BBL)
150
100
50
0
$3
$12
$35
$14
$13
$55
$147
$100
$43
$120
$82

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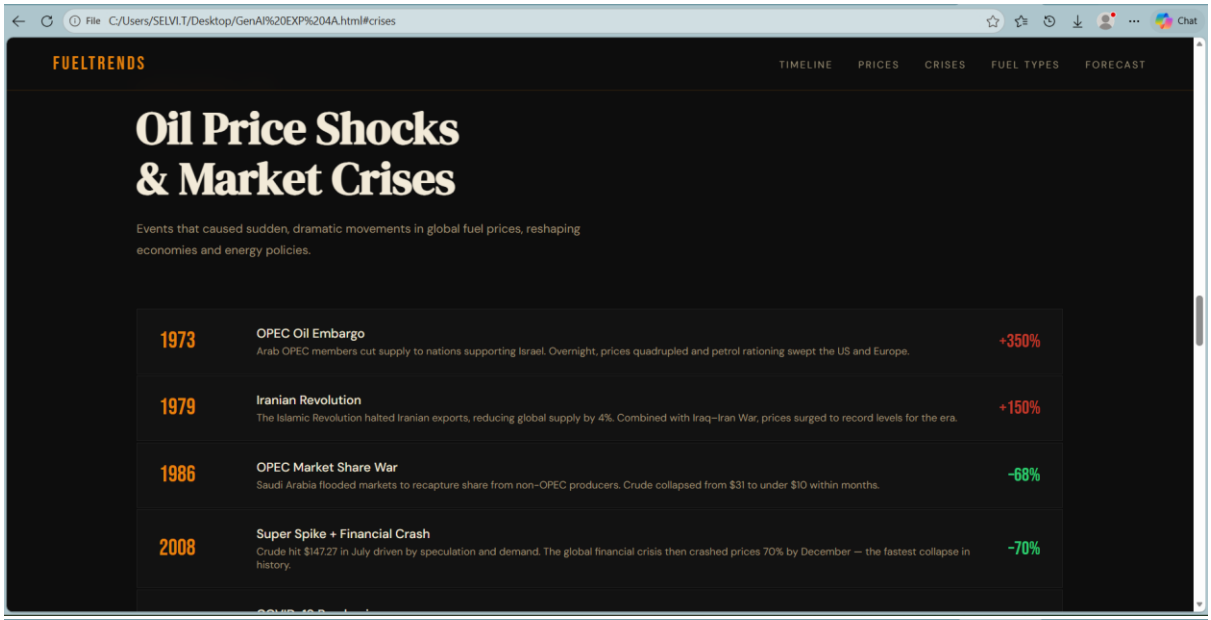
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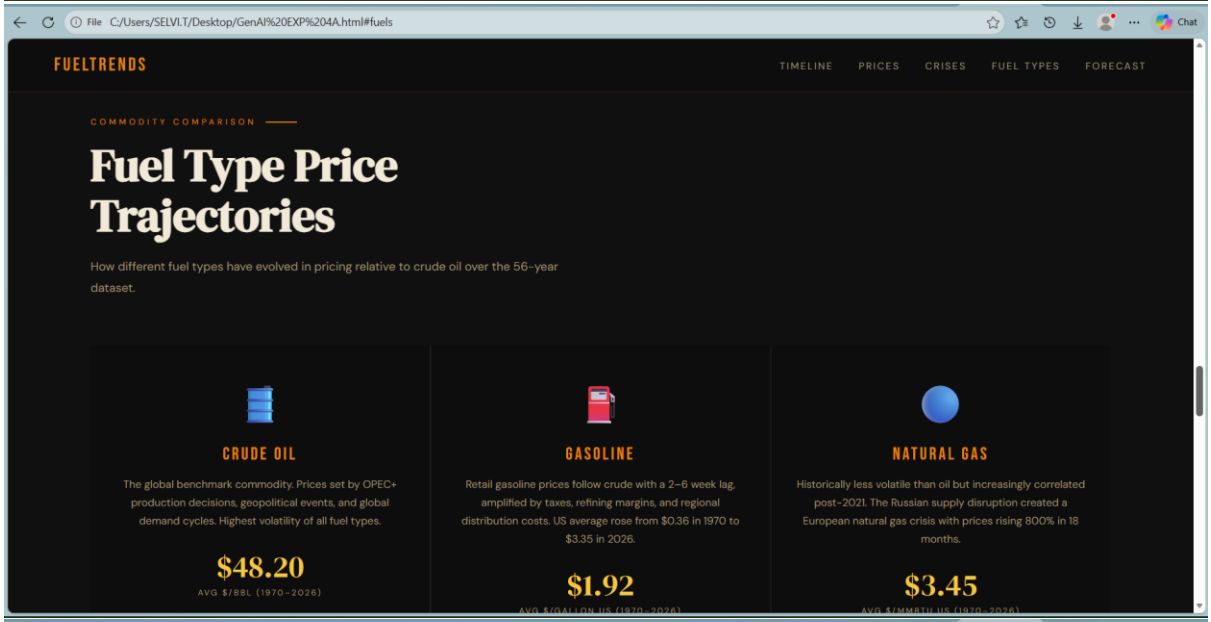
FUELTRENDS
TIMELINE PRICES CRISES FUEL TYPES FORECAST
Oil Price Shocks & Market Crises
Events that caused sudden, dramatic movements in global fuel prices, reshaping economies and energy policies.
1973
OPEC Oil Embargo
Arab OPEC members cut supply to nations supporting Israel. Overnight, prices quadrupled and petrol rationing swept the US and Europe.
+350%
1979
Iranian Revolution
The Islamic Revolution halted Iranian exports, reducing global supply by 4%. Combined with Iraq–Iran War, prices surged to record levels for the era.
+150%
1986
OPEC Market Share War
Saudi Arabia flooded markets to recapture share from non-OPEC producers. Crude collapsed from $31 to under $10 within months.
-68%
2008
Super Spike + Financial Crash
Crude hit $147.27 in July driven by speculation and demand. The global financial crisis then crashed prices 70% by December — the fastest collapse in history.
-70%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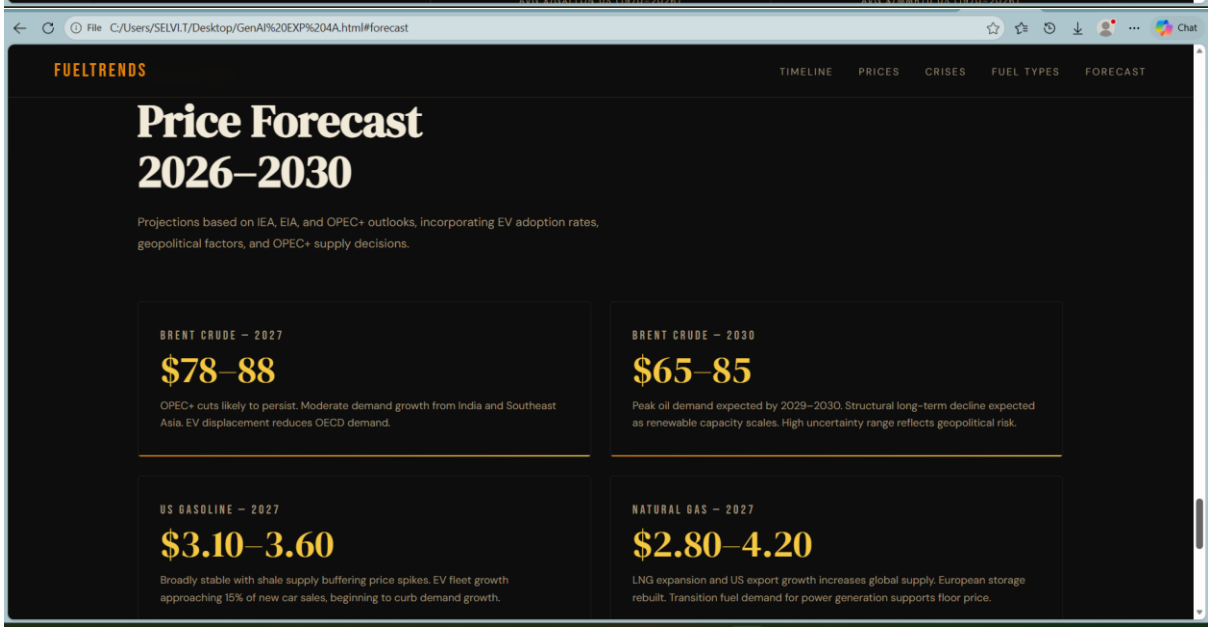
FUELTRENDS
TIMELINE PRICES CRISES FUEL TYPES FORECAST
COMMODITY COMPARISON
Fuel Type Price Trajectories
How different fuel types have evolved in pricing relative to crude oil over the 56-year dataset.
CRUDE OIL
The global benchmark commodity. Prices set by OPEC+ production decisions, geopolitical events, and global demand cycles. Highest volatility of all fuel types.
$48.20
AVG $/BBL (1970–2026)
GASOLINE
Retail gasoline prices follow crude with a 2–6 week lag, amplified by taxes, refining margins, and regional distribution costs. US average rose from $0.36 in 1970 to $3.35 in 2026.
$1.92
NATURAL GAS
Historically less volatile than oil but increasingly correlated post-2021. The Russian supply disruption created a European natural gas crisis with prices rising 800% in 18 months.
$3.45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FUELTRENDS
TIMELINE PRICES CRISES FUEL TYPES FORECAST
Price Forecast 2026–2030
Projections based on IEA, EIA, and OPEC+ outlooks, incorporating EV adoption rates, geopolitical factors, and OPEC+ supply decisions.
BRENT CRUDE – 2027
$78–88
OPEC+ cuts likely to persist. Moderate demand growth from India and Southeast Asia. EV displacement reduces OECD demand.
BRENT CRUDE – 2030
$65–85
Peak oil demand expected by 2029–2030. Structural long-term decline expected as renewable capacity scales. High uncertainty range reflects geopolitical risk.
US GASOLINE – 2027
$3.10–3.60
Broadly stable with shale supply buffering price spikes. EV fleet growth approaching 15% of new car sales, beginning to curb demand growth.
NATURAL GAS – 2027
$2.80–4.20
LNG expansion and US export growth increases global supply. European storage rebuilt. Transition fuel demand for power generation supports floor price.

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